

PAINTING



This cave painting is believed to be 30,000 years old.

Painting began about 40,000 years ago when people painted pictures of bulls, horses, and antelopes on the walls of their caves. We will never be sure why they did this—perhaps it was to make magic and bring people luck in their hunting. Since then,

artists have painted pictures to record events, to honor heroes and heroines, to make people wonder about the world, to tell stories, or simply for pleasure. All artists have their own painting style, and you may not like them all—it's simply up to you.



Hills and valleys

Paintings of the countryside are called landscapes. This Chinese scene looks very different than a Western landscape. It is painted on silk, using a fine and detailed style.

This says "Jan van Eyck was here, 1434." It may be to prove the artist was a witness to the marriage.



If you look closely in the mirror you can see the reflections of two other people. Perhaps one is the artist himself.



Things that are farther away look smaller, so the artist has made the shoes in the front bigger than those in the back. This gives the picture depth.

King Ramses II



by an unknown Egyptian artist

Lucrezia Panciatichi



by Il Bronzino

Self-portrait



by Vincent Van Gogh

Weeping Woman



by Pablo Picasso